Roma Just Talk student invitation

Draft · 28 September 2026 · Team not formed yet

Mom, could you make the introductions?

Could you introduce me to Yuan Ze students who enjoy building things? You do not need to explain Roma or persuade them. Please send either invitation below, then connect me directly with anyone interested. I will show them the app and talk through the work, team rules, and what they want to contribute.

Students interested in software, design, user research, or starting a product could all help. Someone willing to coordinate the Yuan Ze competition team would be especially valuable. A few thoughtful introductions are enough to start.

Roma in one picture

Imagine saying **“Please send the slides”** and pressing the dictation key only after **“Please.”**

What you said	If recording starts at the key press	What Roma aims to capture
Please send the slides	send the slides	**Please** send the slides

Roma keeps a few seconds of recent microphone audio so the beginning of the sentence can be included. The goal is simple: speak naturally without having to restart because you pressed the key late. We have a public Mac beta; we still need to test how well this works for other people.

給學生轉傳｜繁體中文

一起把語音輸入做得更順

你已經開口說「幫我寄這封信」，才想起要按語音輸入鍵；錄下來卻只剩「寄這封信」。Roma Just Talk 想保住句首，讓人不用為了配合快捷鍵重講一次。產品已有公開的 Mac 測試版和原始碼。

我們正在找願意一起做產品的學生。你可以選一塊自己想負責的事：改進 Mac 程式或語音流程、設計好用的操作、找人實測，或把使用者發現整理成產品方向和簡報。歡迎質疑現在的做法；我們會用測試結果決定下一步。不必每個人都會寫程式。

第一站是元智大學元創盃，**2026 年 10 月 16 日 17:00** 報名截止。比賽需要 **3 至 6 位在學學生**，由元智學生任隊長，且至少一半隊員是元智學生。如果合作愉快，我們也可以在比賽後繼續做。Roma 是基於 GPLv3 開源專案 VoiceInk 開發；加入前會談清楚各人的工作、署名、獎金分配和專案權利。

有興趣的話，寫信給 Felix：happyfumd@icloud.com。告訴我你的學校、最想做哪一部分，以及接下來兩週大概有多少時間。我們先聊 20 分鐘、看看產品，沒有加入壓力。

For students to forward | English

Help make voice input easier to use

You say “Please send the slides,” then press the dictation key after “Please.” An ordinary recording misses the first word. Roma Just Talk is a Mac voice-input app that keeps a few seconds of audio so it can include the start of the sentence. There is already a public beta and source code.

We are looking for students who want to build the next version together. Pick a part you care about: the Mac app or speech flow, the way people use it, testing with users, or turning what we learn into a product plan and pitch. Question the current approach. We will use real tests to decide what to improve. Not every role requires coding.

The YZU Startup Challenge is our first milestone. Registration closes **16 October 2026 at 17:00 Taiwan time**. The team needs **3–6 enrolled students**, a YZU student captain, and at least half its members from YZU. If we work well together, we can keep building after the competition. Roma builds on the GPLv3 VoiceInk project; we will agree on work, credit, prize sharing, and project rights before anyone joins.

Interested? Email Felix at happyfumd@icloud.com with your school, the part you would like to work on, and your rough availability over the next two weeks. We can start with a 20-minute conversation and a look at the beta, with no obligation to join.

Roma Just Talk proposal for YZU Startup Challenge 2026

- **Team name:** [Choose with the student team; 20-character limit]
- **Project name:** Roma Just Talk
- **One-line description:** Speak before Shift.
- **Track:** Practical group
- **Field:** AI and information technology
- **Captain:** [YZU student, department and year]
- **Members:** [Names, departments, years, and actual roles]
- **Advisor:** [Optional]

Draft for discussion, not for upload. The final proposal must use the organiser's A4 PDF format. The team name, members, rights statement, and evidence are still open.

1. Summary

Roma Just Talk is a Mac dictation app for people who start speaking before they press a shortcut. With ordinary push-to-talk recording, the first words can be lost; the speaker then pauses, repeats them, or repairs the text. Roma keeps a short microphone buffer on the Mac. When the user presses Left Shift, the app can include those earlier seconds with the rest of the recording and insert the transcript into the active app. Users may choose local recognition or configure a cloud provider.

A beta Mac app and its source are public. What we cannot yet show is how often this problem occurs for other people, whether Roma solves it reliably in their daily work, or whether they would pay for it. The proposed student team would test those questions with Mac users who already dictate, improve the weakest parts of the setup and recording flow, and bring a measured demo to the final. We want introductions to potential testers and advice on Mac app distribution. Roma builds on the GPLv3 VoiceInk project; the proposal will identify VoiceInk's work, Felix's work before this competition, and what the student team adds.

2. Problem and market

Imagine someone drafting a message on a Mac. They start the sentence out loud, then reach for the dictation key. Recording that begins only after the key press misses the opening words. The person has to repeat them or edit the result. Roma addresses that moment.

We have not measured how often it happens. Our first research group would be 10 to 20 Mac users who already dictate several times a day. We would recruit through the public project and local student networks, watch them complete their usual writing tasks, and ask what they use now. We would record missed opening words, corrections, and whether they choose to use Roma again after two weeks. These observations would tell us whether the problem is worth solving before we estimate a larger market.

Typing, built-in Mac dictation, and established dictation apps are all credible alternatives. The question is whether keeping words spoken before the shortcut matters enough for people to change their routine.

3. Solution and technology

The user speaks, presses Left Shift, continues, then releases it to insert text. Roma's short rolling buffer lets the transcription path receive audio from before the key press. The app also has local speech-recognition choices and options for user-configured cloud providers. The product idea is the timing of the interaction. Roma does not claim to have invented a speech model.

Roma is a fork of VoiceInk. VoiceInk supplies much of the existing Mac app, and other open-source libraries support speech recognition and shortcuts. Roma's pre-roll interaction and its handoff from buffered to live audio are work done on the fork. Before submission, the team will attach commit links that separate upstream code, Felix's earlier changes, and new student work. The app remains subject to GPLv3 and the licences of its other dependencies. We will ask the organiser how to describe that history under the form's originality statement.

Local recognition can keep transcription on the Mac after any required model download. Cloud recognition sends audio to the chosen provider. The public beta also has release and privacy limitations, which we will state alongside the demo rather than ask judges to infer them from the source code.

Speech recognition is the AI function in the product. Felix has used generative AI tools while developing and documenting Roma and has made the product and acceptance decisions. The student team will record its own use of those tools for the final AI disclosure.

4. Existing work and validation

The source repository and v1.95.1 Mac beta are public. There is also a browser demo that explains the interaction. It uses the browser's speech recognition, so it cannot stand in for a test of the Mac app.

For this application, we still need a dated recording of the published Mac app capturing words spoken before the shortcut and inserting the result into another app. The separate evidence PDF will state the exact app version, Mac, macOS version, microphone, model, spoken phrase, and inserted text. We have no verified user count, retention result, sales figure, or measured advantage over another app to report here.

The student team will run the same short writing tasks with participants' current method and Roma. It will record the opening words captured, corrections, time to usable text, and failures. A judge should be able to see both successes and limits in those results.

5. Business model

Pricing is undecided. The beta is publicly downloadable, but that does not show demand for a paid product. We will ask frequent dictation users what they pay for now, where those tools fall short, and what they would pay for a reliable fix. We can then test one clear offer with interested users.

Any paid offer must respect GPLv3. The inherited code cannot be treated as exclusive property. Costs we need to measure include release signing, support, and any hosting used for cloud features. The public release is our starting distribution channel; we have not measured how many people it brings in or keeps.

6. Competition

Current option	Why people use it	What Roma needs to prove
Typing and editing	Familiar and precise; no microphone setup	Voice is useful for the tasks we target
Built-in Mac dictation	Already available on the computer	Lost opening words are common enough to justify switching
Established dictation apps	Mature recognition and workflows	Roma's timing benefit outweighs setup and trust costs

A shortcut can be copied. If Roma earns a place in someone's routine, it will be because the whole recording and insertion flow works reliably and the app is clear about permissions and data handling. We need to test that claim with users.

7. Team

Member	School and department	Work in this project	Relevant experience
[YZU student captain]	[Department and year]	Submission, interviews, team coordination	[Fill from actual work]
[Student 2]	[School, department, year]	Mac testing and demo	[Fill from actual work]
[Student 3]	[School, department, year]	Market research and pitch	[Fill from actual work]

[Fill this section after the students agree to join. Name any missing role. Keep Felix's work before the team formed separate from work done by entrants.]

8. Resources and next steps

Date	Work	Evidence that it is done
October 2026	Form the eligible team and submit	The centre sends its registration-success email
November 2026	Test first-word capture with Mac users	Consented task records, including failures and corrections
December 2026	Present the product	Five-minute pitch, three-minute Q&A, tested live demo and video backup
January 2027	Improve installation and first use	Published download tested on named Mac and macOS versions
March 2027	Decide what to offer users	Repeat-use results and responses to a specific price or offer

We would use the centre's help to meet prospective testers and speak with a mentor who knows Mac software distribution and open-source business models. The team will add a costed budget after it checks actual prices. We can consider FITI or U-start with the centre once the team and rights questions are settled.

Source and rights note

VoiceInk is the original GPLv3 Mac app. Roma is a public fork. The final proposal will cite upstream code and dependencies, Felix's existing commits, and each entrant's new work. The organiser's rules require disclosure of third-party technology and its licence. We will seek written guidance on how the existing fork fits the captain's originality declaration before signing it.

Roma Just Talk evidence preview

For the 2026 YZU Startup Challenge practical group. Draft for discussion, not for upload. The team name and Mac test results are still missing. The final evidence PDF will be separate from the proposal.

Public app

Roma's source code and v1.95.1 Mac beta are public. The beta was released on 11 September 2026. This establishes that there is an app to inspect and download. It does not, by itself, show the judge what happens when someone speaks before pressing Shift.

Still needed: Two dated screenshots from a run of the published app. Show the recording state and the text inserted into another Mac app. Beside them, give the exact spoken phrase and output, app version, Mac model, macOS version, microphone, and recognition model. If we use a newer development build, label it with its own version and commit rather than calling it the published beta.

Working demonstration

The browser demo code shows the interaction, but it uses browser speech recognition. It cannot prove the Mac app's recording and text-insertion path.

Still needed: A short recording of the Mac app capturing words said before the shortcut and inserting the full result. Check the exact public link without a login, and keep it available through the final on 11 December. Bring a local copy to the pitch in case the network fails.

Who made what

Roma builds on VoiceInk, which is licensed under GPLv3. The evidence file should credit that work. It should also show which changes Felix made before this competition and which changes the students make after joining.

Still needed: A short table with three to five relevant commits or design records, their dates, authors, and what changed. Ask the organiser how to present the existing fork and founder work under the captain's originality declaration. Do not attribute earlier work to new entrants.

What users say and do

We have no verified active-user count, sales figure, retention rate, or measured speed advantage to put in this file. If the team runs tests before submission, it will report the dates, number of people, exact task, results, and failures. Interviews can explain why someone would try Roma; they are not usage statistics.

The final PDF should contain only results we can trace to a test or public artifact. Check every link without signing in, keep student details private, make the text selectable, and stay below the 100 MB upload limit. The organiser recommends 20 MB or less.